



AFRICAN SOLIDARITY CIVIC ORGANISATION (ASCO)

Registered NPC: 2026/521895/08 | Tax Reference:

9322812265

49 Rif Road, Manor Gardens

Durban, KwaZulu-Natal

4001

info@africansolidaritycivic.org | www.africansolidaritycivic.org

AFRICAN SOLIDARITY CIVIC ORGANISATION NPC (ASCO) INSTITUTIONAL PROFILE, GOVERNANCE & COMPLIANCE PORTFOLIO

Advancing African Solidarity, Human Dignity, Peace and Sustainable Development

COMPLETE HARMONISED VERSION — 10 SEPTEMBER 2026

This portfolio is an institutional profile and governance-support document. It does not replace ASCO's Memorandum of Incorporation, Constitution, Board Charter, Board resolutions, or applicable law.

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PART A — ORGANISATIONAL PROFILE

1. Executive Introduction

African Solidarity Civic Organisation NPC (ASCO) is a community-focused civic organisation based in Durban, KwaZulu-Natal. ASCO promotes social justice, human dignity, constitutionalism, active citizenship, community development, African solidarity and peaceful coexistence through advocacy, education, grassroots initiatives, partnerships and practical community programmes. The organisation is registered as a non-profit company in South Africa and operates subject to its Memorandum of Incorporation, Constitution, Board Charter, approved policies and applicable law.

Message from the Chairperson

ASCO was established in response to the need for principled, community-led civic action that places dignity, equality and solidarity at the centre of public life. Our work is grounded in Ubuntu and in the conviction that communities must be active participants in shaping the decisions and conditions that affect them. We will continue to promote dialogue over division, lawful and peaceful civic participation



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over vigilantism, and practical partnerships over isolation. The Board is committed to transparent stewardship, ethical leadership, responsible use of resources and programmes that are responsive to community priorities.

Message from the Executive Director

ASCO's operational task is to translate its constitutional mission into well-managed programmes that communities can experience and evaluate. We will prioritise disciplined implementation, accurate records, safeguarding, learning and constructive engagement with institutions and partners. Our programme commitments include youth cultural exchange, civic education, community dialogue, anti-xenophobia awareness, youth leadership, environmental sustainability and peaceful public participation. Targets in this portfolio are planning targets unless expressly identified as achieved results and will be reviewed against available resources and Board-approved plans.

ASCO's Journey and Institutional Evolution

ASCO's institutional evolution is understood as a progression from founding vision to structured civic organisation. The founding philosophy emphasises African solidarity, Ubuntu, human dignity, equality, constitutional democracy and practical community service. The organisation's current phase focuses on institutional consolidation: establishing clear governance instruments, developing programme systems, strengthening partnerships, maintaining accountable financial controls and preparing applications or engagements relevant to public-benefit recognition. The medium-term direction is to deepen community programmes in South Africa while developing responsible African and international partnerships, including youth cultural exchange.

The website records current public-facing activities and programme intentions, including a youth cultural exchange and social cohesion focus, community dialogues, civic education campaigns, anti-xenophobia awareness, stakeholder engagement, peaceful demonstrations and environmental sustainability. Public claims about achievements are treated as dated operational information and should be supported by programme records, attendance registers, reports, photographs, financial records or other appropriate evidence.

2. Detailed Organisational Overview and Registration Framework

Item	Verified or approved information
Legal name	African Solidarity Civic Organisation NPC; abbreviated ASCO or ASCO NPC.
Entity type	Non-profit company incorporated under the Companies Act 71 of 2008, subject to the MOI and applicable law.
NPC registration number	2026/521895/08.
Tax reference	9322812265.
Head office	49 Rif Road, Manor Gardens, Durban, KwaZulu-Natal, 4001, South Africa.
Website	https://www.africansolidaritycivic.org/ .
General email	info@africansolidaritycivic.org.
Donations email	donations@africansolidaritycivic.org.
Telephone / WhatsApp	+27 76 757 5773.
Geographic scope	South Africa as the primary operating context, with African and international cooperation where lawful, resourced and approved.



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Membership	Open to supporters in accordance with the Constitution, MOI and Board-approved procedures. Website-listed fees are R20 annual and R100 five-year membership, subject to Board approval and change.
Controlling instruments	MOI, Constitution, Board Charter, Board resolutions, approved policies and applicable law. Where an inconsistency arises, the MOI, Constitution and applicable law prevail to the extent legally required.

3. Historical Background and Founding Philosophy

ASCO's founding philosophy combines African solidarity with civic responsibility. It recognises the shared dignity and interdependence of people living in Africa and seeks to strengthen peaceful cooperation across social, cultural and national boundaries. Ubuntu informs the organisation's emphasis on mutual respect, participation, compassion and collective responsibility. The organisation's humanitarian and community-development orientation requires that assistance and advocacy be delivered without unfair discrimination and with respect for lawful safeguards, privacy and accountability.

4. Vision, Mission and Values

Vision

To build a united, just, inclusive, peaceful and sustainable Africa in which every person's dignity is upheld, communities participate in democratic governance, and shared prosperity is advanced through solidarity and sustainable development.

Mission

ASCO's mission is to promote social justice, human dignity, constitutional democracy, active citizenship, African solidarity, community development, peace, human rights, environmental sustainability, and the empowerment of youth and women through advocacy, civic education, humanitarian and grassroots initiatives, partnerships, and practical interventions.

Values

- Ubuntu and African solidarity
- Human dignity, equality and inclusion
- Integrity, accountability and transparency
- Constitutionalism, justice and the rule of law
- Non-racialism, non-sexism and non-discrimination
- Non-violence, peace and responsible citizenship
- Evidence, participation and sustainable development
- Service, professionalism and responsible stewardship

PART B — PUBLIC BENEFIT MANDATE AND PROGRAMMES

5. ASCO Public Benefit Mandate

ASCO's public-benefit mandate is to conduct activities that are altruistic or philanthropic in character and that benefit, or are widely accessible to, the general public, subject to applicable law and any approval granted by SARS. The mandate is implemented through community development, social



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cohesion, humanitarian assistance, civic education, youth development, cultural exchange, peace-building, environmental sustainability, public participation and partnerships.

- Community development: support community-led responses, resilience and local problem-solving.
- Social cohesion: reduce prejudice, discrimination and division through dialogue, education and cooperation.
- Humanitarian assistance: support vulnerable or disadvantaged communities through lawful, needs-based interventions.
- Education and youth development: build civic knowledge, leadership, cultural understanding and participation.
- Environmental sustainability: promote climate awareness, environmental responsibility and resilient communities.
- Peace and justice: promote non-violent engagement, human rights, constitutionalism and lawful public participation.

ASCO does not distribute income or assets for private benefit. Resources must be applied to approved objectives, subject to reasonable remuneration, legitimate expense reimbursement and bona fide payments permitted by law. This portfolio does not constitute SARS approval as a PBO or authority to issue section 18A receipts.

6. Supporting Programme Descriptions, Targets and Implementation

6.1 Youth Cultural Exchange and Social Cohesion — flagship programme

Purpose: advance peace, mutual understanding and social cohesion through cultural exchange for young people across Africa and beyond. Activities may include reciprocal partner engagement, participant preparation, cultural learning, community visits, reflection and follow-up collaboration.

Planning area	Target / indicator	Implementation and evidence
Reach	At least 50 participants per exchange; target of one international exchange annually.	Partner agreements, participant register, safeguarding checks, travel and activity records.
Partnerships	At least two reciprocal partner countries where feasible.	Written partner confirmations, programme schedule and correspondence.
Learning	Each participant identifies at least three new insights about the host context.	Pre- and post-exchange reflections, feedback forms and learning summary.
Impact	Improved intercultural communication, respect and peaceful-coexistence attitudes.	Participant feedback, follow-up activities and outcome report.

6.2 Community Dialogues

Purpose: facilitate constructive conversation between communities and institutions to build understanding and resolve tension through dialogue. Activities may include listening sessions, facilitated discussions, referral pathways and action tracking.

Target	Implementation	Evidence
Proposed: at least four dialogues per	Community-led agenda, facilitator,	Attendance register, agenda,



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year, subject to resources.	venue or platform, participant safeguarding and action points.	minutes, anonymised feedback and action tracker.
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6.3 Civic Education Campaigns

Purpose: build understanding of civic rights, responsibilities, constitutional values, public participation and lawful engagement. Activities may include workshops, information materials, community talks and digital education.

Target	Implementation	Evidence
Proposed: at least six educational sessions per year.	Plain-language content, trained facilitators, accessible formats and referral information.	Session plans, attendance, materials, feedback and distribution records.

6.4 Anti-Xenophobia Awareness

Purpose: challenge xenophobic narratives and collective blame and promote the rule of law. ASCO's public position is that criminality has no nationality and that immigration matters belong to state institutions, not mobs.

Target	Implementation	Evidence
At least one campaign cycle annually, subject to approval and resources.	Public-awareness materials, dialogue, media or digital communication and lawful partner activity.	Approved campaign materials, distribution records, event reports and media archive.

6.5 Advocacy and Stakeholder Engagement

Purpose: engage institutions and decision-makers to advance social justice, accountability and inclusive development, while building working relationships with communities, faith-based groups, government and civil society.

Target	Implementation	Evidence
Proposed: maintain a stakeholder register and conduct quarterly engagement reviews.	Issue briefs, meetings, consultations, referrals and partnership screening.	Stakeholder register, minutes, correspondence, agreements and follow-up reports.

6.6 Youth Leadership Development

Purpose: equip young people with skills, platforms and support to lead civic initiatives in their communities. Activities may include leadership workshops, mentoring, volunteering and supervised community projects.

Target	Implementation	Evidence
Proposed: at least two leadership cohorts or workshops annually.	Selection criteria, curriculum, mentors, safeguarding and project plans.	Participant records, completion data, mentor reports and project evidence.



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6.7 Peaceful Public Demonstrations

Purpose: support lawful, peaceful and disciplined public participation on issues affecting communities. Any demonstration must comply with applicable law, safety requirements, safeguarding measures and Board-approved procedures.

Target	Implementation	Evidence
No fixed annual target; activities are issue- and approval-dependent.	Risk assessment, lawful notice or permissions where required, marshals, safety and incident procedures.	Approved plan, notices, attendance estimate, incident report and post-event review.

6.8 Environmental Sustainability

Purpose: promote environmental protection, climate awareness, community resilience and sustainable development through education and local action.

Target	Implementation	Evidence
Proposed: at least two environmental awareness or action activities annually.	Community needs assessment, educational content, local partners and practical action.	Activity report, participant record, photographs where consented and outcome notes.

PART C — GOVERNANCE AND INSTITUTIONAL STRUCTURE

7. Governance Framework

ASCO is governed by a Board of Directors. The Board provides strategic oversight, fiduciary responsibility, policy approval, risk management, compliance oversight and protection of the organisation's mission and assets. Executive management is responsible for day-to-day administration and remains accountable to the Board. Directors serving in executive capacities must distinguish Board decisions from executive-management decisions.

8. Board of Directors

The current governance model is based on a four-Director Board structure, subject to the MOI, Constitution, formal appointment records and applicable law. The Board shall act collectively and may establish committees. No operational title alone confers statutory Director status unless appointment or election has occurred under the controlling governance instruments.

Role / person publicly identified	Primary responsibility	Status note
Ms Busisiwe Makhosi Shandu — Chairlady / Founder and Custodian of Founding Legacy	Strategic, ethical and institutional oversight; Board leadership.	Founder recognition and Board role subject to Constitution, MOI and formal records.
Ms Mbali Felicia Dumisa — Deputy Chairperson	Supports the Chairperson and governance oversight.	Public-facing leadership listing; formal appointment records should be retained.
Mr Bhekisisa Shandu — Executive Director	Chief executive and day-to-day operational leadership.	Executive role; Board accountability applies.
Mr Thapelo Nelson Maqalika — Director: ICT and Communications	Digital infrastructure, communications and brand	Director title and authority subject to formal records.



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	governance.	
Mr Khulekani Gumede — Director: People and Culture / Chair: Finance and Procurement	People and culture portfolio and finance/procurement committee work.	Financial authority is controlled by Board resolutions and policies.
Mr Sbhongiseni Mkhwanazi — Head of Legal Services	Legal guidance and regulatory compliance support.	Operational role; not a statutory Directorship solely by title.
Mr Prince Msomi — Head of Organising and Mobilisation	Community outreach and grassroots mobilisation.	Operational role; not a statutory Directorship solely by title.

9. Executive Management and Operational Structure

Function	Responsibilities	Reporting / control
Executive Director	Operational leadership, implementation of strategy, staff and programme management, stakeholder engagement and external representation.	Accountable to the Board; financial authority subject to Board approval.
Head of Legal Services	Legal compliance, governance advice, contracts and regulatory matters.	Advisory/operational role under approved terms of reference.
Director: ICT and Communications	Digital strategy, communications, online presence and brand governance.	Reports through Board or executive structure as formally determined.
Director: People and Culture	Human resources, organisational culture and volunteer management.	Subject to HR, safeguarding and Board-approved policies.
Head of Organising and Mobilisation	Community outreach, events, volunteer coordination and mobilisation.	Subject to programme plans, safeguarding and operational supervision.

PART D — LEGAL, ETHICAL AND COMPLIANCE FRAMEWORK

10. Constitutional and Corporate Documents

ASCO's institutional records should include the Certificate of Incorporation, MOI, Constitution, Board Charter, Board and committee resolutions, registers, approved policies, financial records, programme records and statutory or donor submissions. The website provides public links to the Constitution, Board Charter and MOI. Documents not publicly linked should be maintained in the internal compliance repository with version control and approval dates.

11. Ethical Governance Framework

- Conflict-of-interest disclosure and register of interests.
- Anti-corruption, anti-fraud and responsible procurement controls.
- Whistleblowing, complaints and protected reporting channels.
- Safeguarding of children and vulnerable persons; prevention of sexual exploitation and abuse.
- Non-discrimination, dignity, privacy and responsible information handling.
- Responsible leadership, confidentiality and accountability for representatives, volunteers and contractors.



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- Risk management, incident reporting and corrective-action tracking.

PART E — SARS PBO AND DONOR COMPLIANCE FRAMEWORK

12. PBO Requirements and Application Status

ASCO is preparing or pursuing recognition as a Public Benefit Organisation under section 30 of the Income Tax Act, subject to SARS assessment and approval. This profile records organisational commitments and systems; it does not constitute approval. ASCO must not represent itself as an approved PBO or issue section 18A receipts unless the relevant approval has been separately obtained.

13. Section 18A Readiness Framework

If ASCO later qualifies and applies for section 18A approval, its readiness systems should include donation management, financial accountability, programme reporting, record keeping and beneficiary-impact reporting. Approval, if any, will depend on applicable law, qualifying activities and SARS approval.

PART F — FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT AND ACCOUNTABILITY

14. Financial Governance

- The Board approves budgets, banking arrangements, financial policies, annual financial statements and material commitments.
- At least two authorised signatories approve payments subject to documented limits.
- The Founder/Founding Chairperson is excluded from financial signing and approval authority under the Constitution.
- Funds are used solely for approved organisational objectives.
- Accounting records, supporting documents and audit trails are retained for legally and contractually required periods.
- Restricted grants are tracked separately and used only for approved purposes.
- Donor, tax, PBO and regulatory reports are prepared accurately and submitted when required.

PART G — PARTNERSHIPS AND INTERNATIONAL ENGAGEMENT

15. Strategic Partnerships

ASCO seeks cooperation with community organisations, faith-based groups, government institutions, municipalities, statutory bodies, embassies, international organisations, foundations, academic institutions, civil society organisations and responsible private-sector partners. Partnership selection should consider mission alignment, lawful purpose, safeguarding, conflicts of interest, financial integrity, independence and reputational risk.

PART H — MONITORING, EVALUATION AND IMPACT

16. Measuring Social Impact

ASCO will use proportionate monitoring and evaluation to understand whether activities are reaching intended participants, producing learning and contributing to community outcomes. Measures may include programme outputs, beneficiary reach, participation quality, learning outcomes, community



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feedback, partnership effectiveness, safeguarding incidents, referrals, follow-up actions and documented changes in knowledge, attitudes or behaviour. Website impact figures should be dated and supported by underlying records before inclusion in formal reports.

Level	Examples of measures	Evidence
Inputs	Funding, staff, volunteers, partners, venues and materials.	Budgets, approvals, contracts and resource records.
Activities	Sessions, dialogues, campaigns, exchanges and demonstrations.	Plans, attendance, materials, photographs with consent and reports.
Outputs	Participants reached, sessions delivered, referrals and partnerships.	Registers, referral logs, agreements and dashboards.
Outcomes	Knowledge, confidence, intercultural understanding, dialogue and community action.	Pre/post tools, feedback, interviews and follow-up records.
Safeguarding and quality	Incidents, complaints, response times and corrective actions.	Incident register, complaints log and Board reporting.

PART I — STRATEGIC ROADMAP

17. ASCO Development Plan

The following roadmap is a planning framework and should be confirmed through a Board-approved operational or strategic plan. Targets are not guarantees and depend on lawful approvals, resources, partnerships and community need.

Period	Priority	Indicative outputs
2026–2027 — Institutional consolidation	PBO application, governance strengthening, policy implementation, core programme systems and funding partnerships.	Approved policies, compliance repository, programme plans, partner register, financial controls and initial monitoring reports.
2027–2030 — Responsible continental expansion	African partnerships, youth exchange programmes and international cooperation.	Reciprocal partner network, annual exchange subject to resources, learning reports and documented partnership outcomes.

PART J — INSTITUTIONAL COMMITMENT

18. Institutional Commitment Statement

ASCO is committed to becoming a leading African civic organisation founded on Ubuntu, ethical governance, humanitarian responsibility, constitutionalism, human dignity, peaceful participation, environmental responsibility and global solidarity. ASCO will pursue this commitment through lawful, transparent, community-led and evidence-informed action.

ANNEXURE A — BOARD STRUCTURE

The Board is structured as a four-Director governance body subject to the MOI, Constitution, formal appointment records and applicable law. The Board elects or recognises office-bearers as required by



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the governing instruments. The Founder's historical and honorary recognition does not create ownership, unilateral veto, banking authority or exemption from accountability.

Governance layer	Composition / role	Core accountability
Board	Four Directors, subject to MOI and applicable law.	Strategy, fiduciary oversight, risk, policy, compliance and assets.
Board committees	Finance and Procurement; other committees approved by the Board as needed.	Delegated work under written terms of reference; Board retains ultimate accountability.
Executive management	Executive Director and operational leads.	Day-to-day administration and programme implementation.
Members	Eligible members under Constitution and MOI.	Participation, voting where eligible, compliance and accountability.

ANNEXURE B — ORGANISATIONAL ORGANOGRAM

BOARD OF DIRECTORS



The organogram is a functional representation. It does not by itself appoint a person as a Director, confer financial authority or amend the MOI, Constitution or Board resolutions.

ANNEXURE C — GOVERNANCE POLICY REGISTER

Policy / instrument	Purpose	Status / owner
Memorandum of Incorporation	Primary corporate governance instrument.	Controlling document; Board / members as applicable.
Constitution	Mission, rights, governance, public-benefit and fiduciary framework.	Controlling internal governance document subject to MOI and law.
Board Charter	Board roles, meetings, committees, oversight and conduct.	Board-approved instrument.
Conflict of Interest Policy	Disclosure, recusal, registers and management of conflicts.	Board approval and annual declarations.
Anti-Corruption and Anti-Fraud Policy	Prevention, reporting, investigation and corrective action.	Board approval; applies to representatives and partners as relevant.
Finance and Procurement Policy	Budgets, banking, signatories, procurement and records.	Board approval; Finance and Procurement Committee



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		implementation.
Safeguarding Policy	Protection of children and vulnerable persons and prevention of abuse.	Board approval; mandatory operational compliance.
Code of Conduct and Ethics	Standards for Directors, staff, volunteers, consultants and representatives.	Board approval and induction.
Complaints and Whistleblowing Policy	Safe reporting, response, escalation and non-retaliation.	Board approval; protected reporting channels.
Data Protection and Information Policy	Responsible handling of personal and confidential information.	Board approval; applicable-law compliance.
Monitoring and Evaluation Framework	Indicators, evidence, reporting and learning.	Executive implementation; Board oversight.
Risk Management Framework	Identification, mitigation, incidents and assurance.	Board oversight; management implementation.

ANNEXURE D — PUBLIC BENEFIT ACTIVITIES SCHEDULE

Activity category	ASCO activity	Public benefit rationale	Evidence to retain
Social cohesion	Dialogues, anti-xenophobia awareness and cultural exchange.	Reduces prejudice and promotes peaceful coexistence.	Plans, attendance, materials, feedback and reports.
Civic education	Rights, responsibilities, constitutional values and active citizenship.	Improves informed public participation.	Curricula, attendance, materials and evaluations.
Humanitarian and community support	Needs-based assistance, resilience and referrals.	Supports vulnerable and disadvantaged communities.	Needs assessments, beneficiary records, approvals and distribution records.
Youth development	Leadership, exchange, volunteering and mentoring.	Builds youth capability and intercultural understanding.	Participant records, safeguarding, learning and follow-up reports.
Environment	Awareness, local action, climate resilience and sustainability.	Supports environmental protection and resilient communities.	Activity plans, outputs and outcome notes.
Peace and justice	Mediation, lawful public participation and dialogue.	Promotes non-violence, rights and rule of law.	Risk assessments, notices, incident reports and referrals.
Partnerships	Cooperation with institutions and civil society.	Extends community reach and collective capacity.	Due diligence, agreements, minutes and partner reports.

ANNEXURE E — CONTACT AND INSTITUTIONAL INFORMATION

Field	Information
Organisation	African Solidarity Civic Organisation NPC (ASCO NPC)
Registration	NPC 2026/521895/08



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Website	https://www.aficansolidaritycivic.org/
General email	info@aficansolidaritycivic.org
Donations email	donations@aficansolidaritycivic.org
Telephone / WhatsApp	+27 76 757 5773
Public channels	Website pages for About, Programs, News, Gallery, Membership, Contact and Donate; Facebook link published on the website.
Governance documents published online	Constitution, Board Charter and Memorandum of Incorporation links are published on the website.
Membership fees currently displayed online	R20 annual membership and R100 five-year membership; subject to Board approval and revision.

ANNEXURE F — EVIDENCE AND VERIFICATION REGISTER

The following sources were reviewed when preparing this portfolio. Website statements and operational figures should be dated at the time of reporting and supported by internal evidence.

Source	Information verified	Use limitation
ASCO Constitution 2026 — harmonised version	Vision, mission, objectives, governance, four-Director structure, fiduciary duties, financial controls and conditional SARS wording.	Controlling internal governance document subject to MOI and law.
ASCO PBO Motivation — harmonised version	Section 30 application purpose, public-benefit activities, non-profit safeguards and approval disclaimer.	Application document; not proof of SARS approval.
ASCO website homepage	Registration, tax reference, address, public mission, membership figures, flagship programme and public-facing leadership.	Public information may change; operational claims require records.
ASCO About page	Public vision, mission summary, values, leadership, partnerships and strategic objectives.	Public-facing summary; Constitution and MOI prevail where different.
ASCO Programs page	Flagship exchange, eight supporting programmes, learning outcomes, indicators and recent activities.	Programme targets and descriptions should be confirmed through approved plans and reports.



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BOARD SIGNATURES / ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

CHAIR LADY

Ms. Busisiwe Makhosi Shandu

Signature: 

Date: 6 September 2026

DIRECTOR: HEAD OF ICT AND COMMUNICATIONS

Mr. Thapelo Nelson Maqalika

Signature: 

Date: 6 September 2026

EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR

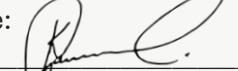
Mr. Bhekisisa Shandu

Signature: 

Date: 6 September 2026

DIRECTOR: PEOPLE AND CULTURE / CHAIRPERSON: FINANCE AND PROCUREMENT COMMITTEE

Mr. Khulekani Gumede

Signature: 

Date: 6 September 2026